CYBER SAFETY GUY

X (FORMERLY TWITTER)
A PARENT'S GUIDE

X is a real-time social network where people share thoughts, news, opinions and media in short posts called "tweets" (now "posts"). It can be a great place to learn and connect – but also a place where harmful content can spread fast. Here's what parents need to know.

500M+
Monthly active users worldwide.

REAL-TIME
News, trends and conversations happen in the moment.

PUBLIC BY DEFAULT
Anyone can see public posts, including your child.

BUILT FOR CONVERSATION
Connect, share and follow people with similar interests.

1 WHAT IS X?



Users post short updates, reply, repost (retweet), like and quote.

Trending topics highlight what's popular right now.

You can follow anyone, including celebrities, influencers and brands.

Posts can be public (visible to anyone) or private (approved followers only).

2 WHAT PARENTS SHOULD KNOW

It's public by default.
Unless your child has a private account, anyone can see their posts, replies and media.

Anyone can reply.
Strangers can reply, quote or mention your child – even if they don't follow them.

Content can be explicit.
Violent, sexual or hateful content can appear in feeds and replies, even on teen accounts.

Trends move fast.
Topics can go viral quickly, including rumours or misinformation.

Not just news.
X is used for memes, gaming, anime, sports, music fandoms and more.

TIP: What looks like a joke or opinion can still be hurtful or influence how your child thinks and feels.

3 SAFETY SETTINGS TO CHECK

- **Protect your posts:** Make your account private so only approved followers can see your posts.
- **Limit who can reply:** Choose who can reply to your child's posts (everyone, people they follow, or verified followers).
- **Filter sensitive content:** Enable "Display media that may contain sensitive content" off.
- **Mute & block:** Mute or block accounts that post unwanted or upsetting content.
- **Location:** Turn off precise location sharing.

Settings can change. Check them regularly.

4 POTENTIAL RISKS

Online abuse & harassment
Strangers can be unkind, send threats or target your child.

Hate & harmful content
Racist, sexist or extremist content can appear in feeds and replies.

Scams & phishing
Fake giveaways, crypto scams and phishing links are common.

Pressure to engage
Trends, likes and replies can create pressure to join in.

Time sink
Endless scrolling and real-time updates can affect sleep and focus.

Remind your child:
They don't have to reply. They don't have to agree. They can block, mute or walk away.

5 TALKING POINTS

- Who do you follow on X and why?
- How do you know if a post or account is trustworthy?
- What kind of content makes you uncomfortable?
- What would you do if someone was unkind or weird with you?
- Is there anything you'd hesitate to show or tell me about X?

Keep the conversation open. Curiosity builds trust.

6 BEST PRACTICES

Think before you post.
Once it's online, it can be screenshotted and shared.

Keep personal info private.
No address, school, phone number or travel plans.

Follow accounts that add value.
News, interests and positive communities.

Report & block.
Use the report function for abuse, threats or illegal content.

Log out on shared devices.
Always sign out when finished.

GOOD TO KNOW

X's algorithm shows content based on what you engage with. The more positive content your child follows and interacts with, the better their experience will be.

7 QUICK START FOR PARENTS

1. Review your child's profile and settings together.
2. Make the account private (if appropriate).
3. Adjust reply and tag settings.
4. Talk about what to share – and what to keep private.
5. Agree on screen time and bedtime boundaries.

A few minutes now can prevent big problems later.

8 WHERE TO GET HELP

Childline: 0800 1111
childline.org.uk
Free, confidential support for any child or young person. You can talk about anything.

The Mix
0808 808 4994
themix.org.uk
Support for under 25s.

Internet Matters
internetmatters.org
Advice, guides and tools for parents.

STAY CURIOUS. | STAY INVOLVED. | KEEP THE CONVERSATION GOING.